If we had to define the essence of the Iranian nonconventional threat to Israel in one sentence, it would come down to the following question: *If and when Iran obtains military nuclear capability, will the decisions of its leadership be rational or messianic?*

The amount of attention and intelligence resources that Israel has invested in dealing with the threat of nonconventional weapons since its establishment is unprecedented, and incomparable with any other issue in the EEI. The buildup of nonconventional weapons in the Middle East has always been under constant surveillance by Israeli intelligence and security bodies, though the subject has gotten the attention of the public only at certain "breaking points." Among these have been the Egyptian use of chemical weapons against the rebels in Yemen in the early 1960s; the activities of German rocket scientists in Egypt during the same period; Iraq's efforts to build up and use all kinds of nonconventional weapons under Saddam Hussein's rule, including the use of chemical weapons against the Kurds and especially its nuclear efforts, including the building of the Osirak reactor, which was bombed by the Israeli air force in 1981; the Egyptian ground-to-ground missile project "Condor" in the 1980s; and the assistance of Pakistan, North Korea, China, and the Soviet Union to certain Arab countries in various areas of nonconventional weaponry. In light of all this, it is fair to say that the State of Israel, since its establishment and to the present day, has coped successfully with the threat of nonconventional weapons, both on the operational, defensive, and offensive level and on the diplomatic, international, and public diplomacy level. The temptation to use nonconventional weapons, whether as a threat or in actual practice, is too great and therefore requires constant counteractions.

As global technology progresses—and it is making giant leaps forward—every variable relating to nonconventional weapons becomes more lethal. Their range increases, their accuracy improves, their miniaturization develops, their carrying capacity increases, warning time decreases, and so on. *For the foreseeable future, I do not see the possibility of Israel being able to reduce the amount of resources it allocates to facing the threat of nonconventional weapons.*

Whereas the State of Israel should be commended for the manner in which it has dealt with various threats involving nonconventional weapons over a long period of time, unfortunately the same cannot be said for the way the state has dealt with the Israeli-Palestinian conflict. However, and at the